



125th Penn Relays Recap

Walking into the Historic Franklin Field with USA across my chest is a surreal experience. From the moment we arrive at the track we are given the red carpet treatment as we are escorted in with security leading the way. The roar of the crowd is intoxicating as Championship of America and USA vs The World events get underway.

The intensity builds as I warm-up and prepare to race. Once on the track the instinct takes over and that feeling can't be explained. This was my fourth opportunity to represent Team USA at The Penn Relays but my first in the anchor position. On a relay team you have no choice but to trust your other teammates because it takes every person doing their part to achieve victory. That day every member of our team ran their heart out giving me a commanding lead. I couldn't afford to lose. As I circled the track hearing the screams of the crowd my only mission was maintaining the lead and crossing the finish line in first, and I used every ounce of energy and emotion I had to get there for the win! Following the race it felt amazing to receive the prized gold watch and stand on that podium. I remember coming to Penn as a collegiate student-athlete at Hampton University and finding my way to the infield just to catch a glimpse and take pictures with the Team USA stars. That experience makes taking pictures and signing autographs with the younger fans the most special now that I have the chance to inspire future athletes.

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IAAF World Relays 2019 Recap

Coming off a successful Penn Relays the USA Team and I were headed to Yokohama, Japan for the 2019 World Relays. This would be my first trip to Asia and I was excited! When I arrived in Japan I was met by members of the team and staff. It was good to see my college teammate Ce'Aira Brown who arrived shortly before and was also competing on the USA team. It took about two days for my sleep schedule to get on track after the 13 hour flight and time difference.

In the days leading up to the track meet I got to know some of the athletes and catch up with others. We explored the city, tried the local food, and did some shopping. Every morning we had team practice at the practice track. I was chosen by the coaching team to once again anchor the Men's 4x400 Relay in the preliminary round.

Race day felt like the longest day there because we didn't race until the evening. When we made it to the track we watched a few of the other teams compete in various events prior to warming up. Everything from there felt like routine and next thing I know I am with the team in a waiting area preparing for our heat to be called up. Once on the track I felt great, I embraced the excitement and nerves to pump myself up to be ready to run. It was also good to have another former teammate of mine, who serves in the US military, standing in the stands near the finish line cheering. Once the gun was shot I could only cheer and prepare myself for whatever position I would be in. I received the baton slightly ahead of Jamaica and held them off for the win. I came back the final day of competition to cheer on all of my teammates in their respective relay finals. The atmosphere because of the fans was electric. They let us know they love the sport and appreciated the athletes.

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To represent Team USA is to represent the best of the best. As I reflect on my athletic career I am more than grateful for these recent opportunities to compete on the global stage. My running career has faced many obstacles, as many track and field athletes do, from injury and finding the time to train while working multiple full and part-time jobs for additional financing. Despite the challenges, I love what I do and will continue to put in the time and effort to be the very best I can be.

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